

Absolutely — **water** is a very strong polysemy target because your passage uses it literally in Monet's subject matter:

> "...as if the **surface of the water** were breathing."

Here **water** means the actual liquid/body of water shown in the painting. But **water** also works as a verb, can refer to a body or supply of water, appears in plural **waters** with territorial/geographical meanings, and develops several important family uses.

# Word family: **water / watery / waterproof / watercolour**

**Base word:** water

**Verb forms:** water, waters, watered, watering

**Related adjective:** watery

**Useful lexical extensions:** watercolour, waterproof, waterway, watershed

**Part of speech:** noun ( 名詞 ) / verb ( 動詞 )

Your source sentence:

> "...as if the **surface of the water** were breathing."

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# Meaning in your passage: **water** = liquid / body of water shown in the painting — 水 ; 水面

Here **water** refers to:

> **the liquid forming the pond/lake surface in Monet's painting.**

**繁體中文 :**

**構成池塘 / 湖面的水 ; 在這句中尤其是「水面」這個整體**

Natural translation:

> "the surface of the water"

「**水面**」

So here:

> **water** = 水 ; 句中整體意思是「水面」

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# 1. **water** = the liquid H<sub>2</sub>O — 水

The core literal meaning.

#### ### Practice 1

> “Plants need \*\*water\*\* to survive.”

「植物需要\*\*水\*\*才能生存。」

#### ### Practice 2

> “Please give me a glass of water.”

「請給我一杯\*\*水\*\*。」

**\*\*water = 無色、無味的液體物質，是人類、動植物生活所必需的基本物質\*\***

Usually uncountable:

> some water

> a little water

not normally:

> \*a water\*

unless referring to a serving/type in specific contexts.

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# 2. **\*\*water = body/area of water ( 地理 ) — 水域；水面；大片水體\*\***

This is very close to your source use.

#### ### Practice 3 — Source-style

> “The light reflected on the \*\*water\*\*.”

「光線倒映在\*\*水面\*\*上。」

#### ### Practice 4

> “The boat moved slowly across the water.”

「小船慢慢駛過\*\*水面 / 水域\*\*。」

**\*\*water = 湖、河、海、池塘等所形成的水體或水面\*\***

Here Chinese often becomes:

- \* 水面
- \* 水域
- \* 水中

depending on context.

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# 3. \*\*waters = sea/river/lake area ( 複數 ) — 水域 ; 海域\*\*

The plural can become more geographical/formal.

#### ### Practice 5

> “These \*\*waters\*\* are rich in fish.”

「這片\*\*水域\*\*魚類資源豐富。」

#### ### Practice 6

> “The ship entered colder waters.”

「那艘船駛入較寒冷的\*\*海域\*\*。」

\*\*waters = 某片特定海域、湖區或河流水域\*\*

This is not just “many waters”.

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# 4. \*\*territorial waters ( 法律 / 國際關係 ) — 領海\*\*

A major formal compound.

#### ### Practice 7

> “The vessel entered the country’s \*\*territorial waters\*\*.”

「那艘船駛入該國的\*\*領海\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 8

> “Fishing rules differ inside territorial waters.”

「在\*\*領海\*\*範圍內，捕魚規則可能不同。」

**\*\*territorial waters = 沿海國依法擁有主權的一定海域範圍\*\***

This is a lexicalized legal/geographical use of plural **\*\*waters\*\***.

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# 5. **\*\*water = water supply / drinking water ( 供應 ) — 用水；供水\*\***

A practical institutional sense.

### Practice 9

> “The village has no clean running **\*\*water\*\***.”

「這條村沒有潔淨的**\*\*自來水 / 供水\*\***。」

### Practice 10

> “The building's water was temporarily cut off.”

「大廈的**\*\*供水\*\***暫時中斷。」

**\*\*water = 日常生活或建築系統中所供應的水\*\***

Natural Chinese may be:

\* 水

\* 用水

\* 供水

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# 6. **\*\*water = liquid used in cooking/mixtures ( 材料 ) — 水；水分\*\***

### Practice 11

> “Add a little **\*\*water\*\*** to the paint.”

「在顏料裡加一點**\*\*水\*\***。」

### Practice 12

> “The soup needs more water.”

「這鍋湯需要再加一點\*\*水\*\*。」

\*\*water = 在烹飪、混合、清洗等過程中使用的液體水分\*\*

This shares the same physical substance meaning, so it should not be over-split.

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# 7. \*\*water = verb, give water to plants — 澆水；灌溉\*\*

A major verb use and especially relevant to your earlier plant passage.

### Practice 13

> “Remember to \*\*water\*\* the plants.”

「記得替植物\*\*澆水\*\*。」

### Practice 14

> “She waters the herbs every morning.”

「她每天早上都替香草\*\*澆水\*\*。」

\*\*water — verb = 給植物 / 土地提供水分，使其生長\*\*

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# 8. \*\*water = supply animals with water — 給動物飲水\*\*

A broader literal verb use.

### Practice 15

> “The farmer stopped to \*\*water\*\* the horses.”

「農夫停下來讓馬匹\*\*喝水\*\*。」

### Practice 16

> “The animals are fed and watered twice a day.”

「動物每天餵食和\*\*供水\*\*兩次。」

\*\*water + animal = 給動物提供飲用水\*\*

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# 9. \*\*eyes water = produce tears — 眼睛流淚；眼睛泛淚\*\*

A very common verb sense.

### Practice 17

> “The smoke made my eyes \*\*water\*\*.”

「煙令我的眼睛\*\*流淚 / 泛淚\*\*。」

### Practice 18

> “Her eyes watered in the cold wind.”

「冷風令她的眼睛\*\*泛淚\*\*。」

\*\*eyes water = 眼睛因刺激、寒風、情緒等產生淚水\*\*

This is a genuine lexical extension of the verb.

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# 10. \*\*mouth waters = produce saliva because food is tempting — 流口水；垂涎\*\*

A common fixed physiological use.

### Practice 19

> “My mouth \*\*watered\*\* when I smelled the food.”

「聞到食物香味時，我\*\*流口水了\*\*。」

### Practice 20

> “The smell of fresh bread made his mouth water.”

「新鮮麵包的香味令他\*\*垂涎欲滴\*\*。」

\*\*mouth waters = 因看到 / 聞到吸引人的食物而分泌更多唾液\*\*

Figuratively, it can suggest strong desire for food.

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# 11. \*\*watering = giving water to plants — 澆水\*\*

A useful family noun/gerund.

#### ### Practice 21

> “The plants need regular \*\*watering\*\*.”

「這些植物需要定期\*\*澆水\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 22

> “Over-watering can damage the roots.”

「\*\*澆水過多\*\*會損害根部。」

\*\*watering = 給植物或土地補充水分的行為\*\*

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# 12. \*\*watery = containing too much water / thin — 水汪汪的；稀薄的\*\*

A major related adjective.

#### ### Practice 23

> “The soup is too \*\*watery\*\*.”

「這碗湯太\*\*稀 / 水分太多\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 24

> “The sauce became watery.”

「醬汁變得太\*\*稀\*\*。」

\*\*watery = 水分過多，令液體、食物或混合物變得稀薄\*\*

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# 13. \*\*watery = pale / weak in colour — 淡薄的；顏色很淡的\*\*

A figurative visual extension.

#### ### Practice 25

> “The sky was a **\*\*watery blue\*\***.”

「天空呈現一種**\*\*很淡的藍色\*\***。」

#### ### Practice 26

> “The painting uses watery shades of green.”

「這幅畫使用了**\*\*淡淡、水洗般的綠色色調\*\***。」

**\*\*watery — colour = 顏色很淡、缺乏濃度，像被水稀釋過\*\***

This is especially relevant to visual art.

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# 14. **\*\*watery eyes (外觀) — 淚汪汪的眼睛；眼睛含淚\*\***

#### ### Practice 27

> “He had red, **\*\*watery eyes\*\***.”

「他的眼睛發紅而且**\*\*淚汪汪\*\***。」

#### ### Practice 28

> “Allergies can cause watery eyes.”

「過敏可能令眼睛**\*\*流淚 / 水汪汪\*\***。」

**\*\*watery eyes = 眼睛產生較多淚水的狀態\*\***

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# 15. **\*\*watercolour / watercolor = painting made with water-based transparent paint — 水彩畫\*\***

A major art-family extension directly relevant to this passage.

#### ### Practice 29

> “The museum has several Monet **\*\*watercolours\*\***.”

「博物館收藏了幾幅 Monet 的**\*\*水彩畫\*\***。」

#### ### Practice 30

> “She bought a small watercolour of the harbour.”

「她買了一幅小型港口\*\*水彩畫\*\*。」

\*\*watercolour = 使用以水調和、通常較透明的顏料創作的畫作\*\*

British:

> watercolour

American:

> watercolor

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# 16. \*\*watercolour = water-based paint / technique — 水彩顏料；水彩畫法\*\*

Same form, another useful countability shift.

### Practice 31

> “She works mainly in \*\*watercolour\*\*.”

「她主要以\*\*水彩\*\*創作。」

### Practice 32

> “Watercolour can create soft, transparent effects.”

「\*\*水彩畫法\*\*可以營造柔和透明的效果。」

\*\*watercolour = 水彩顏料 / 水彩這種繪畫媒介和技法\*\*

So:

> a watercolour = 一幅水彩畫

> watercolour = 水彩媒介 / 技法

Excellent MCQ material.

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# 17. \*\*waterproof = not allowing water through — 防水的\*\*

A major lexical extension.

#### ### Practice 33

> “The jacket is **waterproof**.”

「這件外套是**防水的**。」

#### ### Practice 34

> “Use a waterproof cover outdoors.”

「戶外使用時要用**防水罩**。」

**waterproof** = 水不能 / 不容易穿透的

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# 18. **waterproof** = verb, make something resistant to water — 使防水；做防水處理

#### ### Practice 35

> “They **waterproofed** the roof.”

「他們替屋頂做了**防水處理**。」

#### ### Practice 36

> “The material has been waterproofed.”

「這種材料已經經過**防水處理**。」

**waterproof** — verb = 對物件作處理，使水不容易滲入

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# 19. **waterway** = navigable/natural route of water — 水道；航道

A useful geographical extension.

#### ### Practice 37

> “The river is an important **waterway**.”

「這條河是一條重要的**水道 / 航道**。」

### ### Practice 38

> “The city developed around several waterways.”

「這座城市沿著幾條\*\*水道\*\*發展。」

**\*\*waterway = 河流、運河等供水流通或船隻通行的水上通道\*\***

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# 20. **\*\*watershed = area dividing drainage basins ( 地理 ) — 分水嶺 ; 流域分界\*\***

A more technical but established family extension.

### ### Practice 39

> “The mountain forms a major **\*\*watershed\*\***.”

「這座山形成一條重要的**\*\*分水嶺\*\***。」

### ### Practice 40

> “Rain falling on either side enters different river systems.”

「落在分水嶺兩側的雨水會流入不同河系。」

**\*\*watershed — geography = 把雨水導向不同河流 / 流域的地形分界\*\***

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# 21. **\*\*watershed = major turning point ( 比喻 ) — 分水嶺 ; 重大轉捩點\*\***

A very useful figurative meaning.

### ### Practice 41

> “The invention was a **\*\*watershed\*\*** in modern technology.”

「這項發明是現代科技的一個重大**\*\*分水嶺 / 轉捩點\*\***。」

### ### Practice 42

> “The exhibition marked a watershed in her career.”

「這次展覽成為她職業生涯的一個重要**\*\*轉捩點\*\***。」

**\*\*watershed — figurative = 明確把「之前」與「之後」分開的重大事件 / 轉折點\*\***

Excellent lexical extension.

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# 22. **\*\*waters break ( 生產 ) — 羊水破了\*\***

A common medical/plural use worth flagging.

### Practice 43

> “Her **\*\*waters broke\*\*** during the night.”

「她半夜**\*\*羊水破了\*\***。」

### Practice 44

> “Call the hospital if your waters break.”

「如果**\*\*羊水破了\*\***，請聯絡醫院。」

**\*\*waters — childbirth = 包圍胎兒的羊水，尤其出現在 waters break 這個固定說法中\*\***

Register: especially BrE.

This is a genuinely separate medical use of plural **\*\*waters\*\***.

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# Important distinction: **\*\*water vs waters\*\***

### **\*\*water\*\***

normally uncountable:

> water in a glass

> water in a lake

### **\*\*waters\*\***

can mean:

\* a particular sea/river area;

\* formal geographical waters;

\* childbirth amniotic fluid in fixed usage.

So:

> waters ≠ simply plural bottles of water

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# Important distinction: **water vs liquid**

### **water**

specific substance H<sub>2</sub>O.

### **liquid**

broad physical category.

Oil, milk, paint, and water are all liquids.

So:

> all water is liquid

> not all liquid is water

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# Important distinction: **water vs surface of the water**

Your source says:

> **the surface of the water**

Here:

> water = the body of water itself

> surface = its upper visible boundary

Natural Chinese combines them elegantly as:

> **水面**

rather than:

> 「水的表面」

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# Important distinction: **\*\*water vs sea\*\***

### **\*\*water\*\***

can refer generally to any body of water.

### **\*\*sea\*\***

specifically a large saltwater body.

> “The boat is on the water.”

general.

> “The boat is at sea.”

specifically at sea.

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# Important distinction: **\*\*water vs waters in geography\*\***

### **\*\*water\*\***

general substance/body.

### **\*\*waters\*\***

often formal/geographical:  
a defined region of sea or water.

> international waters

> = 國際水域

> coastal waters

> = 沿岸水域

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# Important distinction: **\*\*water vs moisture\*\***

### **\*\*water\*\***

actual liquid water.

### \*\*moisture\*\*

small amounts of water present in air/materials.

> water the plant

> = 給植物澆水

> soil moisture

> = 土壤水分

They are related but not interchangeable.

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# Important distinction: \*\*water vs watery\*\*

### \*\*water\*\*

noun:

> “Add water.”

### \*\*watery\*\*

adjective:

> “The soup is watery.”

= 湯太稀。

So \*\*watery\*\* does not simply mean “made of water”; it often implies \*\*too diluted / pale / tear-filled\*\*.

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# Important distinction: \*\*watercolour — artwork vs medium\*\*

### Countable:

> “a watercolour”

= 一幅水彩畫

### Uncountable:

> “She paints in watercolour.”

= 她用水彩創作。

Same form, different noun function.

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# Important distinction: **waterproof vs water-resistant**

### **waterproof**

designed not to let water through.

### **water-resistant**

resists water to some degree but may not prevent penetration completely.

So:

> waterproof = 防水

> water-resistant = 抗水 / 防潑水

A very useful product-language distinction.

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# Important distinction: **watershed — literal vs figurative**

### Literal:

> geographical watershed

> = 分水嶺

### Figurative:

> watershed moment/event

> = 重大轉捩點

Same metaphor:

> water divided into two directions → history/life divided into “before” and “after”.

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# Important distinction: **water as verb vs watering**

### \*\*water\*\*

verb:

> “Water the plants.”

### \*\*watering\*\*

noun/activity:

> “The plants need regular watering.”

So:

> water = 澆水這個動作

> watering = 澆水這項活動 / 過程

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# Fixed-expression note

There are several common expressions involving \*\*water\*\*, but because of our default rule against expanding phrasal verbs/idioms unnecessarily, I would \*\*flag rather than fully curate\*\* these here:

\* \*\*in hot water\*\* = 惹上麻煩

\* \*\*like water off a duck’s back\*\* = 完全不受影響

\* \*\*hold water\*\* = 說法站得住腳

\* \*\*test the waters\*\* = 試探情況

\* \*\*muddy the waters\*\* = 把事情弄得更混亂

\* \*\*water under the bridge\*\* = 已成過去、不再追究的事

\* \*\*water down\*\* = 稀釋；比喻削弱內容

These are high-value expressions, but they are best kept under the idiom/phrasal layer rather than treated as separate meanings of bare \*\*water\*\*.

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# Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

\* \*\*water — substance\*\* = 水

\* \*\*water — body/surface\*\* = 水面 / 水域

\* \*\*waters — geographical\*\* = 水域 / 海域

\* \*\*territorial waters\*\* = 領海

\* \*\*water — supply\*\* = 供水 / 用水

\* \*\*water — verb: plants\*\* = 澆水  
 \* \*\*water — verb: animals\*\* = 給動物飲水  
 \* \*\*eyes water\*\* = 眼睛流淚  
 \* \*\*mouth waters\*\* = 流口水 / 垂涎  
 \* \*\*watering\*\* = 澆水  
 \* \*\*watery — diluted\*\* = 稀薄 / 水分太多  
 \* \*\*watery — colour\*\* = 淡淡的 / 像被水稀釋  
 \* \*\*watery eyes\*\* = 淚汪汪  
 \* \*\*watercolour — artwork\*\* = 水彩畫  
 \* \*\*watercolour — medium\*\* = 水彩 / 水彩畫法  
 \* \*\*waterproof — adjective\*\* = 防水  
 \* \*\*waterproof — verb\*\* = 做防水處理  
 \* \*\*waterway\*\* = 水道 / 航道  
 \* \*\*watershed — geography\*\* = 分水嶺  
 \* \*\*watershed — figurative\*\* = 重大轉捩點  
 \* \*\*waters — childbirth\*\* = 羊水 ( 固定用法 )

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## # Master comparison

| Form / sense               | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                      | -----                                 |
| **water — substance**      | 人類、動植物生活所需的液體水                        |
| **water — body/surface**   | 湖、河、海、池塘等形成的水體 / 水面                   |
| **waters — geographical**  | 某片特定海域、河流或湖區水域                        |
| **territorial waters**     | 沿海國依法擁有主權的一定海域範圍；領海                   |
| **water — supply**         | 建築 / 社區系統所提供的生活用水 / 供水                |
| **water — verb: plants**   | 給植物或土地補充水分；澆水                         |
| **water — verb: animals**  | 給動物提供飲用水                              |
| **eyes water**             | 眼睛因刺激等產生淚水                            |
| **mouth waters**           | 因食物吸引而分泌較多唾液；流口水 / 垂涎                 |
| **watering**               | 給植物 / 土地補充水分的行為                       |
| **watery — diluted**       | 含水過多而變得稀薄的                            |
| **watery — colour**        | 顏色淡薄，像被水稀釋過的                          |
| **watery eyes**            | 眼睛產生很多淚水、淚汪汪的                         |
| **watercolour — artwork**  | 使用水彩顏料創作的一幅畫                          |
| **watercolour — medium**   | 水彩顏料 / 水彩這種繪畫媒介與技法                    |
| **waterproof — adjective** | 水不能 / 不容易穿透的                          |
| **waterproof — verb**      | 對物件作處理，使水不容易滲入                        |
| **waterway**               | 河流、運河等供水流通或船隻通行的水上通道                  |
| **watershed — geography**  | 把雨水導向不同流域的地形分界                        |
| **watershed — figurative** | 明確劃分「之前」與「之後」的重大轉捩點                   |
| **waters — childbirth**    | 分娩語境中的羊水，常見於 waters break             |

## # For your original sentence

> “...as if the **\*\*surface of the water\*\*** were breathing.”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*water** = Monet 畫面中池塘 / 水體的水 ; **surface of the water** 整體就是「水面」

Natural translation:

> **\*\*「彷彿水面本身正在呼吸一樣。」\*\***

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **\*\*water\*\*** → 水

> **\*\*the water\*\*** → 某片水體 / 水面

> **\*\*waters\*\*** → 海域 / 水域

> **\*\*water the plants\*\*** → 替植物澆水

> **\*\*eyes water\*\*** → 眼睛流淚

> **\*\*mouth waters\*\*** → 流口水 / 垂涎

> **\*\*watery\*\*** → 稀薄的 / 淡淡的 / 淚汪汪的

> **\*\*watercolour\*\*** → 水彩畫 / 水彩媒介

> **\*\*watershed\*\*** → 分水嶺 / 重大轉捩點